

Coronectomy: Home Care Instructions

Partial removal of a lower wisdom tooth

Patient: _____

Date: _____

What we did today. The roots of your lower wisdom tooth were sitting very close to the nerve that gives feeling to your lip, chin, and tongue. To protect that nerve, we did a planned procedure called a **coronectomy**: we removed the top of the tooth and intentionally left the deep root tips safely in place, away from the nerve. This was the safer choice. Nothing went wrong.

THE FIRST 24 HOURS

- **Bleeding:** some oozing is normal. Bite firmly on gauze for 30 to 45 minutes. Repeat if needed.
- **Swelling:** ice the outside of your face 20 minutes on, 20 off for the first 24–48 hours; after 48 hours switch to warm, moist compresses. Swelling usually peaks on day 2 to 3.
- **Rest:** keep your head propped up and avoid heavy activity today.
- **Do not** smoke, vape, use straws, spit, or rinse hard — for at least **72 hours** (longer is better). These can dislodge the clot that protects the site.

WHAT IS NORMAL

- Soreness, jaw stiffness, and trouble opening wide for several days.
- Mild bruising on the cheek or jaw.
- Swelling that improves after day 3.

DAYS 2 TO 7

- **Rinse gently** with warm salt water a few times a day, especially after meals.
- **Eat soft foods** and chew on the other side. Add normal foods as comfort allows.
- **Keep it clean:** brush the other teeth normally, gently near the site.
- **Medications:** take pain medicine and any antibiotics exactly as directed.

SPECIAL TO THIS PROCEDURE

- The root tips left behind may slowly shift upward over the coming months. This is **expected and good**, because they move away from the nerve.
- Most people never need anything else. Rarely, a small, simpler second visit is done later to remove a root that has moved up. By then it is far from the nerve.
- Brief numbness or tingling in the lip, chin, or tongue can still happen. It usually improves. Tell us if you notice any.
- **Follow-up matters:** we check the area — sometimes with an X-ray — at your review visits over the coming months to watch the root tips as they settle. Please keep those appointments **even if you feel completely fine**.

Call us if you have

- Pain that **worsens after day 3 to 4** instead of improving
- A bad taste, pus, or foul odor from the site
- Fever, or swelling that keeps spreading
- Numbness or tingling that isn't clearly improving by the next morning
- Bleeding that will not stop after 30+ minutes of firm gauze pressure
- Anything that just does not feel right

Trouble breathing or swallowing: call 911 or go to the nearest ER.

Questions? Call our office. After hours, follow the recorded instructions to reach the on-call provider.